Morning Briefing | 2026-10-15

London pre-open

1. HEADER

Thursday 15 October 2026. Generated 06:20 London time (BST, UTC+1). Data collected 05:30 to 06:20 BST via web search. Sources conflict on several intraday figures; ranges are shown where they differ.

2. IMPORTANT NEWS

US September CPI hotter than expected: 3.7% y/y vs 3.6% consensus, core 2.6% y/y, +0.3% m/m
CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Schwab | Fed hike odds for 27-28 Oct meeting reported at 46% to 54%, above 90% for a hike by year-end. Yields and dollar up, tech sold.

Asia tech rout: Kospi -7.7%, Nikkei about -4.8%, Samsung -9.5%, SK Hynix -11.4%
AP via WRAL/Yahoo, Euronews | Chip sell-off on rate fears and fears of peak profit growth and Chinese competition. Risk-off tone into Europe.

Iranian attacks sink two ships in Strait of Hormuz; UKMTO logs 15 attacks since 6 Oct
Washington Post, Euronews | Brent holds above $105 and European gas near a four-year high. Inflation and energy cost risk stays live.

ASML Q3 record sales EUR 11.7bn, Q4 guide EUR 14.2bn to 15.2bn, 2026 guide EUR 44bn to 45bn; shares indicated about 3% lower
Newsquawk, investingLive | Beat and raise, yet stock lower. Signals a high bar for AI-linked names and weighs on European semis.

Bank of America falls 6% to 8% on Q3 revenue miss and reported $1.2bn regulatory fine
TheStreet, Yahoo Finance (figures differ) | Weak start to bank earnings. Read-across to European financials.

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES (PRE-OPEN)

Contract	Level	Expected move
Euro Stoxx 50 futures	n/a for 15 Oct (last quote seen about 6,161, stamped 14 Oct)	n/a
DAX futures	n/a	n/a
CAC 40 futures	n/a (7,875.50 seen, stamped 14 Oct)	n/a
FTSE 100 futures	n/a	n/a
S&P 500 futures	n/a	n/a
Nasdaq futures	n/a	n/a

No reliable 15 Oct pre-open futures quote was found. Context only: Nasdaq closed -1.9% and Asia sold off hard, which points to a weak open. This is inference, not a sourced figure. Collected about 06:15 BST.

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES

Index (14 Oct close)	Close	Change
Euro Stoxx 50	6,188	+0.33%
DAX	25,322	+0.25%
CAC 40	n/a	n/a
FTSE 100	10,725	+0.70%
STOXX 600 (reference)	637.80	+0.4%

Single-source close set (Newsquawk via search snippet). Gains were led by tech after ASML. A CAC close of 7,828 was found but belongs to 13 Oct, so CAC 14 Oct is n/a. European close preceded the CPI reaction on Wall Street.

5. US MARKETS: YESTERDAY'S SESSION

Index (14 Oct close)	Close	Change
S&P 500	7,718.94	-1.1%
Dow Jones	n/a	-0.1%
Nasdaq Composite	26,692.87	-1.9%
Russell 2000	n/a	-1.9%

> **Tone:** worst day since July. Hot CPI revived Fed hike bets and Treasury yields rose. Tech and small caps led losses.

> **Laggards:** Oracle -8.8% (to $130.55), CoreWeave about -15% (bond yield near 15% reported), Bank of America -6% to -8%. **Leaders:** n/a, Dow held near flat, which suggests defensives and value cushioned.

> **Takeaway:** S&P fifth decline in six sessions since its record. Rate-hike repricing is now the market driver.

6. ASIAN MARKETS: OVERNIGHT SESSION

Index (15 Oct)	Level	Change
Nikkei 225	about 64,489 (AP intraday: 64,334.68)	-4.8% (AP: -5%)
Hang Seng	24,071.25	-1.0%
Shanghai Composite	3,713.22	-1.4%
Kospi	5,548.78	-7.7%

Nikkei final close unconfirmed, intraday snapshots differ. Prior close 67,874.

> **Tone:** sharp risk-off. Chip names led: SoftBank -9.6%, Tokyo Electron -7.5%, Samsung -9.5%, SK Hynix -11.4%. Drivers: hot US CPI, rate-hike fears, worries about peak chip profit growth and Chinese competition.

7. COMMODITIES

Commodity	Level	Change	Note
Brent	$105.4 to $106.3	-0.25% to +0.55% (sources differ)	Hormuz attacks keep it above $100
WTI	$95.0 to $95.5	+0.94%	
Gold (spot)	$4,111 to $4,145	-0.4% to -1.2%	Hot CPI and firmer dollar
Natural gas	$3.16 (date not confirmed)	-3.7%	US contract, Trading Economics table
Copper	$6.61/lb	-1.02%	

Settlement times differ by provider. European gas (TTF) reported near a four-year high, level n/a. Collected 05:45 to 06:15 BST.

8. RATES & FX

Instrument	Level	Change
US 10Y yield	5.19% to 5.30%	+9bp at intraday peak, then eased about 2bp
German 10Y Bund	3.46% (3.45 to 3.48)	Lowest since 9 Sep per one source
EUR/USD	1.1135	17-month low per one source
GBP/USD	n/a	n/a
DXY	102.62 (intraday)	+0.43%

US yield and DXY levels are intraday snapshots, not closes. ECB hiked last week (second hike this year). Next ECB meeting 29 Oct.

9. DCM: PRIMARY BOND MARKET

Yesterday's issuances

n/a. No deal-level pricing data for 14 Oct could be sourced (IFR and GlobalCapital are paywalled). Issuer, size, coupon and tightening not reported rather than guessed.

Pipeline / expected today

n/a. No mandates for 15 Oct found.

Key spreads

Index	Level	Move / direction
iTraxx Crossover	301bp at 30 Sep (latest sourced)	Widened from 245bp end-June. Current level n/a
iTraxx Main	n/a	n/a
CDX IG	n/a	n/a
Avg euro corporate IG spread	n/a	n/a
ICE BofA Euro HY OAS	3.26% (8 Oct)	n/a
France-Germany 10Y spread	above 130bp	Widest since 2012 (Bloomberg, early Oct)

Commentary

Credit came under pressure in late September as higher government yields and heavy supply hit spreads (Pareto, 12 Oct). Q3 euro HY issuance was EUR 27.1bn, second-strongest third quarter on record. US big tech is now close to 10% of gross euro non-financial corporate supply (ECB). A PureGym deal priced in line but softened on the break. After hot US CPI and the equity sell-off, expect a cautious tone and wider new issue concessions today (inference, not sourced).

Fixed income data is thin this morning. Treat as incomplete.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR

London time	Indicator	Consensus	Importance
13:30	US PPI, September (m/m)	+0.5% headline, +0.3% core	High
13:30	US retail sales, September (m/m)	+0.3% (ex-autos +0.5%; one source +0.1%)	High
13:30	US initial jobless claims (w/e 10 Oct)	195K to 200K (prior 197K)	Medium
n/a	Eurozone and UK releases	n/a (none sourced)	n/a

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS

Charles Schwab (SCHW): Q3 earnings listed for 15 Oct on one calendar only. Unconfirmed.

ASML: reaction to Q3 results and raised guide (reported 14 Oct). Shares indicated lower.

SEB: Swedish regulator imposed a temporary capital add-on over internal credit risk model weaknesses.

UBS: Swiss parliamentary committees voted in principle for a lump-sum fee on large banks with foreign operations.

Full Europe earnings and AGM list for today: n/a.

12. STOCKS TO WATCH

Company	Reason	Probable direction
ASML	Record Q3, guide raised, but shares indicated about 3% lower. Supply to fall short of demand in 2027 and 2028	Down at open, then watch for dip buyers
European semis (read-across)	Asia chip rout (Kospi -7.7%, Tokyo Electron -7.5%) and Nasdaq -1.9%	Down
SEB	Temporary capital add-on from Swedish regulator	Down
UBS	Swiss bank fee proposal advances in committees	Down / pressured
Credit Agricole	Deal to buy IKB (13 Oct); shares indicated lower	Down
European banks	BofA -6% to -8% on revenue miss; higher yields mixed for margins	Mixed to down
Energy, tankers, defence (sector view)	Brent above $105, Hormuz attacks. No single name sourced	Supported (inference)
Charles Schwab	Earnings possibly today (unconfirmed)	Volatile

Aviation, shipping, metals and mining: no specific sourced catalysts found. Copper -1% and gold down on dollar strength.

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

Macro

> US CPI 3.7% y/y, gasoline +9.1% m/m drove half the rise. Core 2.6% y/y.

> Fed hike probability for late October about 46% to 54%. Year-end hike above 90%.

> ECB raised rates last week, second hike this year. Markets price about 2.8% deposit rate by December and a small chance (about 13% in one source) of a hike on 29 Oct.

> Bank of England: n/a.

Corporate

> ASML beat and raise, shares lower. Orders booked through 2030.

> Bank of America Q3 revenue miss. Q3 bank earnings season off to a rocky start.

> Credit Agricole to buy IKB.

Political / geopolitical

> Iranian attacks on Gulf shipping at highest recent intensity. JMIC rates threat 'severe'.

> Saudi Arabia and the Houthis exchange strikes. US midterm politics reported to be pausing a US move on Iran.

> Euro area sovereign spreads: France-Germany above 130bp, Italy-Germany at widest since May 2025 (13 Oct).

14. KEY THEMES: TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5

> **US PPI and retail sales**: A hot PPI would reinforce hike pricing after CPI.

> **Tech sell-off follow-through**: Asia chips -5% to -11%; test of Europe's semis and ASML.

> **Hormuz and oil**: Brent above $105 feeds the inflation story.

> **Bank earnings tone**: BofA miss sets the bar for European financials.

> **Yields and dollar**: US 10Y near 5.2% to 5.3% and EUR/USD at multi-month lows pressure risk assets.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

> **Fed hike repricing**: Odds near 50% for October reshape rate-sensitive sectors.

> **Q3 earnings season**: Banks and tech set the tone; next week lists about 215 US reporters.

> **Hormuz shipping risk**: More sinkings would lift Brent and freight.

> **French and Italian spreads**: Wide sovereign spreads spill into credit and banks.

> **Korea and Japan chips**: Further drawdown would hit global semis.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

> **Fed meeting, 27-28 Oct**: A hike would be the first move in the new tightening leg per market pricing.

> **ECB meeting, 29 Oct**: Third hike of the year is a minority call but live.

> **US midterms, early November**: Policy and Iran-war decisions may be shaped by the vote.

Q3 earnings run: Guidance on AI capex and bank credit quality.

Oil above $100: Persistent energy inflation keeps central banks hawkish.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY: US PPI and retail sales at 13:30 London. Whether Europe's semis follow Asia lower. Brent reaction to new Hormuz incidents. Treasury 10Y holding above 5.2%.

1 WEEK: Continued Q3 bank and tech results. Fed pricing versus data. Sovereign spread moves in France and Italy. Credit primary market appetite for supply.

1 MONTH: Fed 27-28 Oct and ECB 29 Oct decisions. US midterms. Whether the AI-chip drawdown becomes a broader correction. Energy supply through Hormuz.

Sources: CNBC, Yahoo Finance, AP via WRAL/ClickOrlando, Euronews, Washington Post, TheStreet, Newsquawk, investingLive, Schwab, Kitco, Trading Economics, Investing.com, Forbes, Pareto Securities, FRED (ICE BofA), ActionForex, Admiral Markets, Bloomberg.

Data collected automatically. Verify before making any decision.